

Carne Asada Picada

Three phases: 1 marinade / butcher / freeze · 2 salsa · 3 cook · the full taco

PORTION	THAW = MARINATE	DICE	FREEZER
450 g bags	overnight, fridge	$\frac{3}{8}$–$\frac{1}{2}$" cross-grain	3+ months

PHASE 1 MARINADE FORMULA % of beef wt · per full ~24 lb (11 kg) clod — weigh yours, multiply

Beef shoulder clod diced $\frac{3}{8}$ – $\frac{1}{2}$ ", across grain	100%	11 kg
Granulated garlic background	0.5%	55 g
White onion rough chunks, to blend	4%	440 g
Maggi seasoning Jugo — umami backbone	2%	220 g
Neutral or olive oil	3%	330 g
Salt Diamond Crystal — with Maggi, ~1% total sodium	0.6%	66 g

BUTCHER → MARINADE → FREEZE build ahead — the freeze + thaw does the marinating

- 1 Butcher / dice:** trim the shoulder clod and cut $\frac{3}{8}$ – $\frac{1}{2}$ " (**1–1.5 cm**) **cubes across the grain** — uniform for even searing, cross-grain for tenderness.
- 2 Blend the marinade:** everything except the beef into a blender — blend smooth (a splash of water to get it moving if needed). It scales clean and coats evenly for bulk.
- 3 Combine:** toss the diced beef in the blended marinade until every piece is coated — a large tub / bus tub for a full clod.
- 4 Portion + freeze:** into quart bags (**450 g** each), press flat, remove air, label with the date, freeze **right away** — **no separate marinate step**.

Asada Salsa

Toasted guajillo + árbol, fresh-charred tomatillo — simple, raw-blended, bright

YIELD	ACTIVE	HEAT	KEEPS
~2 cups (480 ml)	~30 min	Dial via árbol	4–5 days, fridge

PHASE 2

INGREDIENTS

toasted chiles + fresh-charred tomatillo — raw-blended, no crutches

Guajillo chiles stemmed, seeded — color, body, mild	6
Chiles de árbol stemmed — the heat AND the dial	8
Tomatillos husked, charred — or 2 cans Embasa verde	~1 lb
White onion thick slabs, to char	½
Garlic skin on, to char	3 cloves
Salt Diamond Crystal — to taste	to taste
Lime only if it reads flat — usually not needed	to taste

METHOD

toast · soak · char · blend · salt — no frying, no reducing

- 1

Toast the chiles. Guajillo + árbol on the **cool edge of the Ooni** (or a comal over medium, ~350–400°F) — **15–30 sec/side**, just fragrant and bendy, **zero black spots** (burnt = bitter, the whole batch). Pull any that scorch.
- 2

Soak. Cover with **hot (not boiling) water**; soak **20–30 min until soft**. **Dump the soaking water** — it's bitter; don't blend with it.
- 3

Char the fresh stuff. Char the **tomatillos, onion, and garlic** hard on the Ooni until blistered and soft. Peel the garlic.
- 4

Blend. Everything — drained chiles, tomatillos, onion, garlic — with a splash of **fresh water** to loosen; blend smooth. Pass through a sieve once for **zero grit**.
- 5

Salt & done. Salt to taste. Lime only if it reads flat (fresh tomatillo is already tart). That's it — raw-blended, fresh, bright. **No frying, no reducing.**

Heat dial: the árbol count, nothing else — more for hotter, fewer for milder.

Cook & Build

COOK TARGETS

this stage — the griddle

Griddle surface (IR)	450–500°F	Internal pull temp	130–140°F
Char coverage	15–20%	Final texture	crusty edge, tender

PHASE 3

COOK FROM FROZEN

ripping-hot griddle — sear, don't steam

- 1 Thaw:** fridge **overnight** — it seasons as it thaws, and with **no acid there's no mush risk**, so a full thaw is fine. **Pat dry** going in for a clean sear.
- 2 Griddle:** cast iron / flat-top ripping hot (**IR 450–500°F**), light oil. **Single layer, don't crowd** — pat surfaces dry going in. Hard sear.
- 3 Chop-and-sear:** add fresh sliced white onion alongside if you like; chop with two spatulas, let it sit **30–60 sec**, toss for crispy edges.
- 4 Finish & build:** pull at **medium, 130–140°F**. Double-stacked tortillas, the seared beef, then **fresh lime, the Phase 2 salsa, raw onion + cilantro, flaky salt**. Brightness *and* heat both come on at the table.

TROUBLESHOOTING

PROBLEM	CAUSE	FIX
Tough / chewy	Cut with the grain, or overcooked	Dice across the grain; pull at 130–140°F
No char	Griddle too cool or crowded	Single layer; recover to 450–500°F
Dull, no brightness	No acid in the bag (by design)	Fresh lime + salsa at the table — that's the brightness
Gray, not seared	Wet surface or crowded pan	Pat dry going in; smaller batches; hotter pan
Not spicy enough	Salsa milder than the table wants	More árbol in the salsa (Phase 2)